



English Democrats Manifesto and Constitution

Manifesto and Constitution of the **English** Democrats

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SECTION 1 - *Introduction; Aims and Objectives*

1.1.1 The aims and objectives of the English Democrats are set out in this and succeeding manifestos.

The broad aim of the English Democrats is to build a society which accommodates the interests of all the people of England. We aim to do this in an enlightened and democratic way.

1.1.2 It would be unrealistic at this stage for the English Democrats to set out detailed policies on every issue.

We believe that good politics is a matter of good judgement and pragmatic decision-making within the bounds of general principles and objectives. We have set out below the general principles and objectives that guide us.

1.2 Democracy

1.2.1 We are committed to government of the people, by the people, for the people. Those with power to affect our way of life must be answerable to the people.

1.2.2 Democracy is much more than the ability to choose, from time to time, between broadly similar parties which compete amongst themselves for power. Real democracy is measured by the ability of the people to manage their political, economic, physical, and cultural environment.

1.3 Guiding Principles

The English Democrats will be guided by the following general principles:-

- ✓ 1.3.1 The state should serve the collective interests of its citizens.
- ✓ 1.3.2 We wish to see a modern and wide-ranging Bill of Rights founded on traditional English civil liberties.
- ✓ 1.3.3 The English Democrats seek a far ranging freedom of access to information.
- ✓ 1.3.4 Wherever reasonably practicable, public appointments should be chosen by direct election.
- ✓ 1.3.5 Power should be devolved, as and when practical, within all spheres of government and service provision, including, for example, the education and health services.
- ✓ 1.3.6 Devolution within England should be through the existing system of local government, subject to modifications that are necessary to meet the needs of a workable and efficient democratic system.
- ✓ 1.3.7 The aim should be to enable local people to identify with Local Authorities. We must reverse the trend towards remote and unaccountable decision-making.
- ✓ 1.3.8 We favour - recognition for traditional counties, which would include the reunification of Yorkshire.
- ✓ 1.3.9 We favour the use of referenda in local government with a view to using referenda in other tiers of government if the experiment proves successful. A system similar to that used in Switzerland should be the model. This would enable citizens to petition for a referendum on certain policy issues. Proposed changes to the constitution should be referred to the electorate in referenda. The results should be binding. There could be a role here for the Second Chamber as guardian of the constitution. Rules are needed for the timing and funding of referenda with the aim of making them as fair as possible to all parties involved.

1.4 Liberty

1.4.1 We support moves to maximise individual liberty and reduce state involvement in people's lives.

1.5 A Parliament for England

1.5.1 Democratic fairness for England is needed, via a referendum on the creation of an English Parliament, Executive and First Minister with at least the same powers as the Scottish Parliament, Executive and First Minister within a federal UK and a reformed Second Chamber at Westminster.

1.5.2 There should be fiscal devolution so that the English, Scottish, Welsh and N. Irish parliaments become responsible for financing their own expenditure. This will save the taxpayers of England a substantial amount of money.

1.5.3 We reject the plans for regional assemblies because, among other things, they will promote disunity and conflict with England.

1.5.4 The English Democrats' will study the future findings of the English Constitutional Convention (ECC), and may accommodate ECC findings within future party policy.

We demand action on the following matters;

1.5.5 England to be recognised and treated as a unified country. Scotland and Wales have been recognised as countries and their people given the opportunity to vote in referenda for devolved government. Scotland now has a parliament, and Wales an assembly. In contrast, the people of England have been denied the opportunity to choose an English Parliament. Instead, England is being dismembered into nine regions. We find this discrimination unacceptable. England should be a political entity with its own parliament and executive.

1.5.6 The immediate abandonment of the Barnett formula. The *formula* institutionalises discrimination against the people of England by ensuring that public spending in Scotland and Wales is far higher per head of population than in England. The Barnett formula diverts about £12 billion of extra public expenditure to Scotland each year. This means that the entire population of Scotland enjoys an additional unfair subsidy. This has meant, for example, smaller class sizes in Scotland, higher pay for teachers, shorter hospital waiting lists, and the availability of prescription drugs and surgical procedures which are unavailable in England on grounds of cost. This unjustified discrimination must end. A new fairer system is needed which enables England's share of the £12 billion to be used to improve public services in England.

1.6 The English Flag

1.6.1 We call for the compulsory flying of the English flag, the cross of St George, on all state-maintained public buildings in England.

SECTION 2 – Devolved Matters

2.1 The division of our aims and objectives between Section 2 and Section 3 is broadly in line with the current arrangement made for Scottish devolution. Section 2 contains *devolved* matters, which would be the responsibility of the English parliament and executive. Section 3 contains *reserved* matters, which would continue to be the responsibility of the UK parliament and government.

2.2 Public Services

2.2.1 We believe that it is the responsibility of government to ensure that all citizens have access to high quality healthcare and education, which should be free at the point of supply. Public services should not be seen as a minimal safety net for the less fortunate.

2.2.2 While all public services should be the responsibility of government, where appropriate, use should be made of the private sector to provide the elements that make up those services.

2.2.3 It is important that our finite resources be used as efficiently as possible. Government should be responsible for providing a police force and judicial system which enjoys public confidence.

2.2.4 The immediate provision of public services should not be gained at the cost of long-term debt. We have no right to defer the cost of services so that they become a burden for future generations.

2.3 State Accountability

2.3.1 We call for the state to publish clear and comprehensive annual accounts, in the same way that private companies do. These comprehensive public accounts would list all taxes collected and list all expenditure items, and would link to detailed information on each specific area.

2.3.2 We call for this information to be accessible from a single website.

2.4 Health

2.4.1 We are committed to making the National Health Service an efficient organisation which provides a high quality service for all citizens.

2.4.2 The need for improvement is such that it may be necessary to adopt a simplified approach to structure and management.

2.4.3 The priority given to a patient's treatment should be based on medical need, not artificial management targets. Bearing this in mind, we would create a N.H.S. Inspectorate on a similar basis to the very successful schools Inspectorate. Its purpose would be to raise standards of service, ensure equal quality of healthcare throughout England, and check malpractice in both the NHS and the private healthcare sector.

2.4.4 *Care in the Community* as a policy has manifestly failed, not only to protect the public, but also to protect the mentally ill, partly through inadequate funding. English Democrats policy is that as long as it is considered that an individual poses a significant risk either to themselves or to the public, they should remain in secure care.

2.4.5 NHS services must not be made freely available to non-nationals.

2.4.6 All those entering the UK must have valid health insurance covering their stay. Those seeking residency must provide proof of passing full health checks by an accredited clinic or doctor for HIV, Tuberculosis, Leprosy, Hepatitis and other diseases if such are prevalent in their home country.

2.4.7 Entrance into the UK will not be permitted for those who have contagious or debilitating illnesses which could threaten public health, compromise their private health insurance, or are likely to place an unacceptable burden on the NHS.

2.5 Disability

2.5.1 The English Democrats would seek means for providing greater education, training, and employment opportunities for the disabled and chronically sick.

2.6 Education

2.6.1 As in other public services, there is a need to constantly improve standards. The quality of education should be equal throughout England.

2.6.2 England's prosperity is not based on natural resources but on the skills and enterprise of her people. Our well-being is bound up with the quality of education and training. Education is an expensive investment but ignorance is even more costly, in personal, economic and social terms. A substantial proportion of the funds released to England from the ending of the Barnett formula should be used to reduce class sizes, increase teachers pay, and improve buildings and equipment.

2.6.3 We recognise that for social and economic reasons, some sections of the English population do not appreciate the importance of providing their children with a positive attitude to education. This lapse has contributed to the emergence of an anti-authority youth-culture which sees education and the discipline needed for successful learning as a form of repression to be rebelled against. This is part of a wider social and cultural problem that cannot be tackled by teachers and funding alone.

2.6.4 The English Democrats would encourage positive attitudes to education as part of a wider programme for promoting communal values. When education is widely seen as an aid to greater freedom, happiness and prosperity, schools will become more pleasant places for pupils and teachers, and educational standards will rise.

2.6.5 Primary & Secondary Education-

2.6.5.1 The English Democrats support parental choice. Where there is a demand for it, schools should be able to free themselves from local education authority control and be run independently in a way that suits local needs.

2.6.5.2 The English Democrats support the continued work of the Schools Inspectorate in the provision of independent information on the quality of education in schools.

2.6.6 Higher and Continuing Education-

2.6.6.1 The English Democrats would provide greater resources for continuing lifetime education and thereby enhance the opportunities open to all citizens.

2.6.6.2 An Inspectorate similar to that of the Schools Inspectorate should monitor and report on the education and effectiveness of all continuing education establishments in England.

2.6.7 Balance in Education-

2.6.7.1 The English Democrats advocate a rebalancing of education so that craft & vocational options are given equal emphasis to academic options.

2.6.7.2 Our non-academic people must be valued and praised.

2.6.7.3 We oppose the lowering of academic standards in order to increase graduate headcount statistics.

2.6.7.4 Academic examination standards should be restored to a pre-1985 level.

2.7 Transport

2.7.1 Only the state can bring together the resources and long-term strategic planning that is necessary for the creation of an integrated transport infrastructure.

2.7.2 Transport policy should give proper weight to economic, environmental and public service considerations. All of these issues need to be taken into account when planning and building a cheap, efficient and safe integrated transport system.

2.7.3 There should be greater local involvement in transport planning and a more equal distribution of resources throughout England.

2.7.4 Greater use should be made of light railways, trams, cycle-ways and pedestrian friendly areas.

2.7.5 The motorist has become an easy target for prosecution and fund-raising. The imposition of speed cameras has become a revenue raising exercise. Prosecuting motorists does not count as fighting crime. Motorists already pay, via fuel tax and road fund licences, far more than is needed to maintain and improve the road network. Too much emphasis is placed upon road tolls, bridge tolls, speeding fines, congestion charges as well as parking fines and penalties. Speed cameras should only be used as a last resort and only for safety reasons.

2.7.6 Proposed improvements to the transport network have been shelved by the government citing costs, and yet Scotland continues to benefit from like schemes. There should be a review of all transport projects

abandoned by the government to ensure that England is treated fairly.

2.7.7 It is unfair that foreign vehicles should have free access to our road network. A toll should be introduced on all vehicles entering this country to ensure that they pay the full cost of the wear and tear on our road system which they cause.

2.8 Housing

2.8.1 Housing supply and pricing is being severely distorted by the levels of immigration into England. First time buyers find it difficult to afford a home of their own and need to take on large mortgages and the attendant interest payments, in order to do so. Social housing is currently insufficient to meet demand.

2.8.2 With our pledge to bring mass immigration to a complete end and to expel illegal immigrants, then the pressure on housing will be lessened.

2.8.3 The English Democrats advocate a fairer points system for the allocation of social housing, giving greater priority to local people and those who are married and in work. Publicly funded affordable housing purchase/rental schemes should only be available to first time buyers who are citizens of this country.

2.9 Agriculture and Fisheries

2.9.1 English agriculture should be organised and, where necessary, financed in a way that suits English interests. Likewise, English fishing grounds should be treated as a national resource and be managed by a body which includes representatives of the English fishing industry.

2.9.2 The aim of English agriculture should be to provide good quality food at a reasonable price. This should be done in a way that is environmentally friendly. Concern for the environment should not cause us to lose sight of the fact that the primary role of farmers is to produce food.

2.9.3 The whole array of agricultural subsidies and marketing schemes needs overhauling. The strategic aim should be to help those in temporary need, and secure reliable supplies. To this end we favour greater use of targeted support, and fewer general subsidies.

2.9.4 Support, where appropriate, would be provided for farmers who wish to switch away from *factory farming* to mixed farming and organic production.

2.9.5 Schemes to encourage the local production and distribution of food will be developed.

In all areas of agriculture we should seek more environmentally friendly and healthy production.

2.9.6 We should strive to ensure that all rules and regulations which are applied to domestic production are also applied to imports.

2.10 Ecology and the Environment

2.10.1 The English Democrats believe that the resources of land and sea should be used in a way which gives due consideration to the long-term consequences. Each generation holds the environment in trust for future generations. We should not leave them to bear the cost of our selfish and short-sighted behaviour.

Guiding principles

2.10.2 The English Democrats recognise the shortcomings of the Kyoto Treaty but support initiatives which aim to guide us to a low carbon economy.

2.10.3 Zero-pollution hydrogen fuel-cell power-packs are available, sized to power vehicles through to large buildings and entire localities. We support programmes to develop a hydrogen supply infrastructure, with particular focus on hydrogen originally created using renewable energy. We support the establishment of English pilot towns that will generate their own power using hydrogen fuel cells. We call for the scheme to be rolled out across England upon successful completion of the pilot trials.

2.10.4 Greater use of renewable resources and the more efficient use of energy. This should include encouragement for *Green* industries, especially energy generation, and the construction of energy efficient buildings.

2.10.5 Laws to prevent and deter pollution. The polluter should be made to pay.

2.10.6 Controls on noise pollution from roads, airports, domestic, and other sources.

2.10.7 All major planning decisions should be subject to an efficient and speedy system of public enquiry with the final decision being made by an English Parliament.

2.10.8 The English Democrats promote much tighter restrictions on green-field development and a better use of brown-field sites.

2.10.9 The English Democrats encourage the use of local building materials and designs throughout England. Greater consideration should be given to aesthetics. Our towns and cities have for many years been plagued with ugly buildings and uninspired uniformity of design. The fault for this often lies not with architects or planners but with those who determine the allocation of funds. Too often the overriding consideration for new buildings and development projects is cost. Modern architectural designs and building techniques could, in the proper place, greatly improve our environment.

2.10.10 Improvement in building standards, e.g. better sound insulation and larger minimum room sizes.

2.10.11 The English Democrats will initiate greater local control of planning and other environmental issues.

2.10.12 The English Democrat will promote viable village communities with affordable accommodation for the young.

2.10.13 Animal experimentation is to be sanctioned only in connection with human health and where no practicable alternative exists.

2.11 Policing

2.11.1 Policing is an increasingly difficult job due to changes in our society, which now lacks the social cohesion and shared values that once gave us a mostly peaceful and well-ordered way of life. Our cities have become places where it is impossible to perform traditional communal policing.

2.11.2 English Democrats seek a return to a system of policing which recognises the principle that all citizens are treated equally. In their efforts to prevent crime and catch criminals the police should not be hindered and demoralised by unreasonable ideological constraints.

2.11.3 We should not lose sight of the fact that the basis for the maintenance of law and order in England rests on a firm foundation of active participation by law-abiding citizens. A relationship of trust and co-operation between citizens and police is essential to effective policing and the prevention of crime. With that in mind, it is reasonable to expect that policing should not be oppressive. The aim is a peaceable society in which liberty and justice can flourish.

2.11.4 It is essential that the police force be adequately trained and resourced.

2.11.5 Police forces should be more democratically accountable than at present. This would require the election of Chief Constables or the Police Authorities which appoint them.

2.11.6 English Democrats call for the creation of a scheme enabling businesses to pay for their security staff to train and register as Special Constables, their powers of arrest applying to their place of work and its neighbouring streets. Such registered security staff would be subject to Police staff performance monitoring and discipline.

2.12 The Legal System

2.12.1 The primary role of a legal system is to provide the means for settling disputes. It should enable those who suffer loss, in the form of personal injury, theft, or damage to property, to be properly compensated by the party at fault. Laws, and the penalties for breaking them, should comply with the principles of natural justice. As societies have become more complex, so have their law codes. To a great extent, this is unavoidable.

2.12.2 However, states and their governing elites are extending the reach of law into areas that infringe upon individual liberties. The result is a body of law which is more restrictive and complex than it need be.

Many of the customs and principles of English law are being undermined in the political quest for greater conformity with Continental ideas and practices. Law is being used as a tool for imposing dogma. One of the consequences of these changes is that the police are increasingly being made the enforcers of political doctrine and moving further away from their traditional role of upholding the delicate balance between Order and Liberty.

2.12.3 In order to obtain justice, citizens must feel able to consult and employ the services of the legal profession. Many people are deterred from this by the procedures and costs of the present legal system. Improvements have been made in recent years but more needs to be done to make the system *user friendly* and efficient.

2.13.4 The English Democrats favours less law and a simplification of law. There are far too many matters currently covered by the criminal law. There should be a drastic reduction and rationalisation of the number and extent of criminal offences.

2.13.5 We must reform the jury system but not abandon it because the jury provides a democratic check on the legal system. The law is not the property of lawyers; it belongs to the people and should serve their needs. Our preference is for a return to comprehensible, just and effective law. Given its current chaotic state, the law should be codified.

2.13.6 Once the criminal law has been properly codified, the English Democrats would ensure that the criminal law is vigorously policed and enforced.

2.13.7 Except in an emergency there should be a single annual implementation date for new law. This will help rectify the current muddled situation where no one can be sure, without considerable effort or expense, whether a clause of a new Act has been brought into force or not. Also, some rules, for example the Civil Procedure Rules, are being rewritten so frequently that new editions are being published more than once a month! This leads, not surprisingly, to the shameful situation where no-one, not even the judiciary, can be sure of the current rule in force without first making unreasonable efforts to research the point.

2.13.8 In order to avoid such excessive complexity developing again, a monitoring system should be devised which ensures that new law is unambiguously comprehensible and properly and efficiently enforceable. This could be a function of a reformed Second Chamber.

2.13.9 The English Democrats respect the right of victims of crime to defend themselves and their property against criminals. The English Democrats would extend the right of self-help.

2.13.10 The English Democrats believe that every victim of a criminal offence should have the right to address the court on the question of sentence and for the court to be required to bear the victim's views in mind when passing sentence.

2.13.11 It is not acceptable that 100,000 *hardened* criminals commit over half of all crime in the U.K. Once a criminal is identified as beyond effective rehabilitation he or she must be kept out of the community until no longer a risk.

2.13.12 Prisons should be designed and equipped so that prisoners are not subject to degrading conditions

2.14 Drugs and Alcohol

2.14.1 English Democrats believe that government should encourage a healthy lifestyle which makes the minimum use of "recreational" drugs of all kinds and only reasonable use of alcohol. The Government's drug policy is failing to control the use of illegal drugs and its alcohol policy appears to be making the problems worse.

2.14.2 The English Democrats favour an independent and open minded, English enquiry into alcohol and drug abuse. This should consider, amongst other issues, the pros and cons of legalising the use of cannabis and its health and social consequences. The enquiry should consider health and social consequences. We recognise that there are good arguments on either side. What is needed is a proper conclusion to the debate for England so that it is possible to move on with an agreed stance and suitable measures.

2.15.3 It is clear that the current policies for dealing with problems of addiction are not working adequately and there is an ever rising tide of criminality arising from, in particular, drug abuse. Addiction problems are very difficult to solve and require careful analysis. One particularly frustrating aspect of addiction is that family and friends are often aware of the plight of the addicted person but unable to do what is best for them. One area of reform should be greater provision for addicts to be subject to compulsory treatment in secure care.

2.15.4 All those who commit criminal offences whilst under the influence of drugs or alcohol should be subject to compulsory assessment and if found to be addicted should immediately be taken into such care.

2.15.5 The most important aspect of the fight against drug dealing criminals is that any policy should seek to destroy their market, protect the public, and punish offenders.

2.15.6 The English Democrats intend to raise gaol sentences for drug dealing in Class A drugs graduating from a fixed five year term as a minimum doubling it for any subsequent re-offence.

2.15.7 Registered Class A drug addicts will be placed in secure drug rehabilitation schemes rather than sent to prison, where active participation in the detoxification programme will be a requirement of their sentence. Failure to comply with the detoxification programme may result in secure custody within a prison environment as per a graduated tariff based on previous antecedence.

2.15.8 Addicts with children will be put on the 'at risk' register and custody of children will be dependent on an addict's ability to detoxify. Addicts failing to successfully complete detoxification will not have their children returned to them, the rights of the children must be paramount and either familial custody or foster parents will be sought until detoxification has been completed. The return of children will be conditional on regular detoxification checks.

2.15.9 Addicts wishing to seek help for their addiction will be registered at a specific medical centre, one which is outside of the GP network.

2.16.10 The government will provide a dedicated County based Drug Management Service for those who are addicted to Class A drugs. Registration as a drug addict will require regular visits to the centre under a personally structured drugs management programme.

This might include:

2.16.10.1 Maintenance doses of drug to which the person is addicted whilst awaiting to attend a detoxification scheme

2.16.10.2 Provision of supervised medical care and clean syringes to minimise contamination & safe disposal.

2.16.10.3 Maintenance doses for repeatedly defaulting addicts

2.16.10.4 Family Health Visitor Sessions - to ensure children of ex addicts are thriving

2.16.10.5 Employment/Training/Housing referrals and counselling

2.16.10.6 Those who commit criminal offences, and who are found to be using drugs, will be expected to prove that they were not funding their drug use by their criminal activity. Those who fail to do so will be placed on a drug's rehabilitation programme and will be detained until they have been free of drug use for 6 months. Upon release, they will be monitored to ensure that they remain drug free and will be re-detained if they fail to do so.

SECTION 3 – Resolved Matters

3.1 Families

3.1.1 It is often overlooked that our society is founded on the institutions of marriage and family life. The family is the place where cultural and moral values are most successfully passed from one generation to the next.

3.1.2 The English Democrats favour the promotion of marital families, consisting of mother, father and children, as the preferred building block of our society.

3.1.3 The English Democrats wish to create a social and financial environment where men and women can enjoy the opportunity of a career and also raise a family.

3.1.4 New attitudes and practices are needed so that raising a family is no longer seen as a second best option to the maximisation of wealth and leisure.

3.1.5 We need families with children because without them our nation and way of life will cease to exist.

3.1.6 We need young people to train as nurses, doctors, police, teachers, soldiers and all the many other occupations that a society requires.

3.1.7 It is English Democrat policy to strive to make family life culturally desirable. We will advocate taxation and welfare policies that are conducive to family life.

3.2 Pensioners

3.2.1 There should be proper provision of pensions and care for elderly citizens so that they are able to enjoy a decent standard of living.

3.2.2 The following objectives should be pursued.

3.2.2.1 The best pension entitlement that can be afforded.

3.2.2.2 A tax system that rewards rather than, as at present discourages thrift.

3.2.2.3 A more flexible retirement age, thus allowing people more freedom to choose the date of their retirement.

3.2.2.4 Improvements in the provision of specialised medical care and services for the elderly.

3.3 The Economy

3.3.1 **A Mixed Market Economy**—The English Democrat favour a market economy but not an unrestrained market economy. Trade and industry should, within reason, meet the needs of the society within which it operates. Societies should not be expected to subvert their democratic and cultural institutions in order to meet the needs of trade and industry. More consumption does not necessarily produce more happiness. A healthy economy is a mixed economy.

3.3.2 The English Democrats promote expansion of our manufacturing sector and halt the trend towards an over-reliance on service industries. It is a fallacy that manufacturing industry is low-tech *metal-bashing* which can be replaced with service industries. Most of the service sector does not provide high-tech jobs. Catering, retailing, warehousing, and call-centre work is mostly low-tech, low paid work. The aerospace, electronics, pharmaceutical, and engineering industries should be the bedrock of our economy and the core around which a high-skill, high-pay service sector is built. In furtherance of this policy, and in the interests of a healthy economy, there should be an industrial policy which promotes and expands manufacturing industry. Manufacturing is an essential part of a modern and prosperous economy.

3.4 Economic Independence

3.4.1 Appropriate encouragement and targeted support should be given to ensure that certain strategic resources are produced in England. Complete self-sufficiency is impossible but we should ensure that we are not placed in a position where we are unable to defend our vital interests because we lack control of the necessary strategic resources.

3.4.2 Our economy and currency should be managed, as far as possible, by our own government. States may be less independent than they once were but we should resist those who would leave our economic well-being in the hands of global corporations and institutions. We should retain what independence and control we have and strive to gain more.

3.4.3 The English Democrats advocate support for core “strategic” industries without which England would not be able to maintain her economic well being. Many vital, highly capital-intensive industries are unlikely to be restarted by private entrepreneurs alone. Examples are energy (including coal mining); agriculture, manufacturing (including shipbuilding, bearings and machine tools), transportation, water, aviation and defence to name but a few.

3.4.4 There should be some emphasis on supporting strategic industries in the North of England, where there is less overcrowding and more affordable housing for workers.

3.4.5 A key method of support to these strategic industries is for the public sector to purchase from them, especially during downturns in their open market.

3.4.6 The English Democrats also favour support to these industries from the government intellectually, educationally and via private-public financing arrangements, although we recognise that there isn't a prevalence of business skills and experience within government circles.

3.4.7 As a last resort, where it is necessary to avoid the loss of a strategic industry, we advocate the purchase of a government-held "golden share" which can be sold as and when the industry regains stability.

3.4.8 We recognise that England's ability to implement its own industrial strategy is impaired by its being subject to EU authority: the English Democrats support EU withdrawal, subject to referendum authorisation.

3.5 A One Country Economy

3.5.1 There should be a more equal spread of government, and government directed spending throughout England. This objective could be furthered by an English Parliament committed to ensuring that good public services and the infrastructure for a modern economy exist in all parts of England.

3.6 Taxation

3.6.1 We call for honesty in taxation policy.

3.6.2 We oppose the imposition of stealth taxes, such as the tax on pension scheme dividends, because such dishonest taxes are tantamount to theft by the state.

3.6.3 We support the ring-fencing approach to taxation for major areas of public expenditure such as health and pensions, whereby taxes are collected for a specific purpose and the state cannot redirect those funds to a different purpose.

3.7 Employment & Welfare Provision

3.7.1 We believe that the government should pursue policies which provide the conditions necessary for full employment.

3.7.2 Welfare payments should, where possible, be linked to employment and retraining schemes. We support the principle of National Insurance benefits, such as Unemployment Benefit, providing short to medium term relief. Income Support should provide a net for citizens with dependent families or other commitments requiring additional support.

3.7.3 The National Insurance system has been allowed by successive governments to become unacceptably open to abuse. There are currently millions more National Insurance numbers than the adult population of the whole of the United Kingdom. The scheme should be immediately overhauled to prevent fraud and duplication.

3.7.4 Once this process has been completed, there should be vigorous enforcement of the rule those persons without a valid national insurance number should not be allowed to undertake paid employment or claim any form of welfare benefit.

3.7.5 Child maintenance allowances or any public monies paid to parents for their children should only be claimable if the child is resident in the country. Such allowances are only to be paid to citizens of this country.

3.7.6 Obtaining allowances to which people are not entitled through fraud or deception should carry a prison sentence and the possibility of the confiscation of assets to repay fraudulent claims.

3.7.7 Any provision of welfare for non-citizens should only be on the basis of reciprocal rights between states.

3.8 Sovereignty

3.8.1 Sovereignty is the ability to make and enforce law subject to no higher authority.

3.8.2 Sovereignty belongs to the people, who lend it to democratic institutions.

3.8.3 We have the inalienable right to determine the nature of the institutions which exercise our sovereign powers and the conditions on which they do so.

3.9 The European Union

3.9.1 The English Democrats favour European co-operation and trade but not a European political entity which undermines the independence, sovereignty, and democratic institutions of European states.

3.9.2 European integration, as conceived by the Frenchman Jean Monnet, had the aim of tying Germany into a network of political and economic links with France and other European states so that it would be impossible for Germany to go to war with them. That was by no means the only motivation for seeking ever-closer political and economic union. The interests of Germany and France came together in the peculiar circumstances following World War II. Advantage could be gained for both by combining a post-war German economic revival with French political and agricultural dominance. Germany gained a secure market for its manufacturing industry and France gained a protected market and financial support for its agriculture. In addition, France obtained privileged access to the European market for its colonial produce, and took the lead in building European institutions on the French model – centralised and bureaucratic. The aim from the beginning was to enmesh the states of Europe in an economic, political and military union from which they could not break free. That goal was, and still is, considered more important than the democratic nicety of explaining the goal to the electorate and seeking its approval.

3.9.3 The states of the EU cannot be successfully run as either an economic or social whole. Their economic and cultural circumstances are very different. Each needs to be governed in a way which accords not only with material needs but also with the democratic, cultural and other traditions of the indigenous nations. The one-size-fits-all approach of EU institutions is a recipe for disaster.

3.9.5 The EU has become a top heavy and outdated bureaucratic hulk which is unsuited to an age when the people of Europe need democratic nation-states to protect them and their unique cultures from the excesses of global corporations, global institutions and the global economy. The EU is a part of the problem, not the solution.

3.9.6 The English Democrats will seek referendum authorisation to decide this country's future relationship with the E.U. That referendum should include the option of leaving the EU and joining the European Free Trade Association, EFTA, whose countries have a free trade agreement with the EU.

3.9.7 The English Democrats believe that this country should leave the EU and will campaign forcefully to that end.

3.9.8 If, in a referendum, England votes to leave the EU, then the English Democrats believe that we should so leave. It is the English who make the payments to the EU and the other UK nations rely upon the English to continue to do so. In a referendum, the English Democrats would set out the costs that would need to be paid in order to keep the UK as a whole in the EU. The electorate has a right to know the amount of tax which they might be expected to pay.

3.9.9 If England votes to leave then all payments to the EU should cease forthwith and England should re-assert its own sovereignty vis-à-vis the EU. This would involve taking back powers that have been ceded and our own territorial waters.

3.9.10 On leaving the EU, we would hope and expect that the other UK nations would likewise leave in order to preserve a cohesive British state and avoid unnecessary division. In the event of one or more of the other UK nations preferring to remain in the EU – then England should leave the EU nonetheless, unilaterally if necessary.

3.10 The Euro

3.10.1 The English Democrats reject the principle of a European currency because it would bring a loss of economic and political independence. It would strike at the very heart of our democratic institutions. Our stance does not arise from a sentimental attachment to the Pound or to tradition; it is founded on the belief that an independent, successful, and democratic state needs its own currency. Our well-being and way of life will be better protected if we are able to govern ourselves and thereby determine our own economic, social, and cultural priorities. We will also be better placed to make the most of our assets and focus on finding solutions to our problems.

3.10.2 The principle reasons argued for promoting the Euro are as follows:

3.10.2.1 To end a system that in effect makes the US dollar a global reserve currency. That situation gives a great economic and political advantage to the USA. Among other things, it enables US businesses to buy foreign assets at favourable exchange rates. It also allows the USA to run massive trade deficits. Other states are in effect subsidising US consumption.

3.10.2.2 To bind the states of Europe together in a political and economic system from which they cannot break free.

3.10.3 While the first aim is laudable, and the benefits of success would be great, the method employed is impracticable and damaging. It will end in economic and social disruption on a massive scale. The second aim is undesirable on many grounds, not least those of democracy and cultural diversity.

3.10.4 The British people face constant propaganda which seeks to convince them that the Euro is an inevitable part of unstoppable progress. We are led to believe that its adoption is merely an adjustment to modern needs; an aid to consumer convenience; something that is welcomed without misgivings elsewhere in a more progressive and enlightened Europe. It is suggested that the Euro is a purely economic matter, the decision to join being dependent only on the technicality of meeting *the* five economic tests. In reality, the full ramifications of a single European currency are much wider than portrayed. In addition to its economic impracticability and inefficiency, it would prevent us having democratic control over the management of our economy and our way of life.

3.11 World Trade

3.11.1 Global corporations should view their ability to trade in a society as a privilege, not an absolute right. Governments should do their best to ensure that global corporations treat their societies no less favourably than others. For example, if corporations choose to regard the world as a global market when considering labour and other production costs, they should also treat it as a global market when it comes to pricing. If they produce in China their prices for goods and services should reflect that. Differential pricing zones are a hindrance to fair and free trade and should not be tolerated.

3.11.2 Changes need to be made to the rules of the World Trade Organisation (WTO) and the way it is governed. Our government should take the lead in pushing for reform of WTO rules and structure, or produce plans for a new organisation to take its place. Any attempt to resurrect the Multilateral Agreement on Investment (MAI), or something similar, should be resisted.

3.11.2.1 The *Multilateral Agreement on Investment* was scheduled to be signed in spring 1998 but it was so ambitious and extreme that it proved impossible to gain the necessary support. The aim of MAI was to ensure that global corporations could operate beyond the control of states. If MAI or an agreement like it ever came into effect, it would make corporations the legal equal of states. Corporations would be able to move capital and plant around the world as they pleased and sue any state which interfered. MAI was to be an institution, similar to WTO and the World Bank, with an appointed body which would enforce its rules.

3.11.3 The English Democrats advocate a “fairs fair” policy of international reciprocity, whereby England matches any restrictions imposed by other countries that adversely affect England. For example, English companies aren’t allowed to take control of Swiss companies, so the reverse should be applied.

3.11.4 We recognise that England’s ability to implement its own international reciprocity policy is impaired by its being subject to EU authority: the English Democrats support EU withdrawal, subject to referendum authorisation.

3.12 Globalism

3.12.1 Our parliamentary democracy is being weakened. One of the principal reasons for this is that the UK government and Westminster parliament are no longer responsible for many areas of policy and legislation. Power is steadily passing to the European Union, global institutions, and global corporations. Powerful organisations over which we have no democratic control are creating political and economic structures that serve their interests not ours. In doing so, they are destroying our way of life and communal cohesion.

3.12.2 The globalism being inflicted on us is neither desirable nor inescapable. It is not the product of an inevitable historical process. We need not stand by and allow our identity and way of life to be sacrificed to its needs.

3.13 Defence

3.13.1 The English Democrats supports continued membership of NATO as a strictly defensive alliance which does not interfere in the internal affairs of its member states.

3.13.2 Our armed forces should enjoy the highest standards of training and equipment. Their primary role should be as a fighting force. The resources devoted to them should match the commitments they are expected to fulfil. The main purpose of our armed forces should be to protect our country and the interests of its people.

3.13.4 The English Democrats are opposed to the use of our forces in operations where they are in effect serving as mercenaries of a foreign state.

3.13.5 Members of the armed services who suffer injury in the service of their country should be quickly and properly cared for and compensated.

3.13.6 We would retain a nuclear deterrent but explore other means for providing an effective strategic defence.

3.14 Foreign Policy

3.14.1 The English Democrats seek a global system consisting of independent nation-states, each with its own identity, character, and culture. Each state should be free to trade in a way that suits its needs and customs.

3.14.2 The English Democrats favour special co-operation and links with those states, wherever they may be, which uphold the principles of national self-determination and fair trade.

3.14.3 Overseas aid should be provided in furtherance of these ideals and in accordance with the needs of English national interests.

3.14.4 Our history as a maritime trading power has provided us with a unique web of relationships, of which we should make use. We are in a position where we need not be ruled by either Brussels or Washington. We need the self-confidence and will to forge a truly independent foreign policy.

3.15 Immigration

3.15.1 We need to change immigration policy so that it better reflects the needs and wishes of the people of England.

3.15.2 There should be a points system for entry to the UK which is based on the Canadian and Australian model. Points should be awarded for, among other things: educational and professional qualification; family links with England; financial resources; the ability to speak English. In other words, entry should be determined by our needs as a society and the ability of newcomers to be absorbed into the prevailing public culture. High priority should be given to creating a peaceful society which is bound together by shared values and perceptions.

3.15.3 The wishes, security and interests of the people of England should be the dominant factors in determining asylum and immigration policies for England.

3.15.4 Should there be an economic need for immigration it should be met by the employment of people on fixed term work permits.

3.15.5 Our aim should be to meet the need for skilled workers from within. A points system should be used to bring an end to mass immigration and only allow that immigration which is in the national interest. A points system should not be used to facilitate and legitimise a continuation of mass immigration.

3.15.6 Immigrants should not be a burden on the taxpayer and should be economically self-sustaining. This requires that the wages paid to immigrants should be at a level necessary for those immigrants to pay sufficient tax revenues to meet expected welfare and other public sector costs – or else that their employers make payment for the shortfall. Furthermore, immigrants and/or their employers should make payment a capital sum to reflect a full contribution to the existing capital wealth of the nation, such as schools, hospitals, roads, housing etc. Those potential immigrants who are unable or unwilling to make these payments will not be allowed into the country.

3.15.7 International law is not fixed for all time. We should not feel bound by rules that were devised several decades ago when circumstances were very different. Asylum seekers should seek asylum in a state adjoining or nearby the state from which they are fleeing. None of the UK's immediate neighbours are terrorising regimes. The UK should refuse to accept any further asylum seekers and should instead give financial assistance to genuine refugees in their own or neighbouring countries, where such financial assistance will have the greatest beneficial impact.

3.15.8 In order to end the mass inflow of asylum seekers into the UK, the UK must withdraw from the 1951 UN Convention on Refugees.

3.15.9 Our principal concern is to preserve and build on what is left of English cultural unity and social cohesion. The preservation of our identity and culture are at least as important as economic considerations.

3.15.10 The English Democrats do not accept the fallacious but widely publicised economic arguments for mass immigration. For the most part they greatly exaggerate the economic benefits and wholly ignore the economic, social, and cultural costs. The people of England have never voted for nor supported mass immigration.

3.15.11 The English Democrats support whatever measures are necessary to bring mass immigration to a complete end. Such measures should include:

3.15.11.1 Thorough border controls with all inward and outward movements through ports being logged to provide the best quality information on migration movements.

3.15.11.2 Stronger visa requirements for countries with a reputation for illegal movements.

3.15.11.3 The deportation of all illegal immigrants. There should be no amnesties. Illegality should not be rewarded by the granting of citizenship. Nor should organised crime rackets be allowed to profit from people smuggling. Discovered illegal immigrants should be offered the choice between cooperatively returning straight home, or being sent to a distant offshore holding centre during the processing of their repatriation case.

3.15.11.4 The repeal of the Human Rights Act and the withdrawal of the UK from the European Convention on Human Rights. Both of these flawed items of legislation have perversely assisted criminals while offering little of substance to the law-abiding population.

3.15.11.5 Punitive fining and possible withdrawal of trading rights of companies, company directors and other employers who employ illegal immigrants.

3.15.11.6 The deportation of all those immigrants who have been convicted of a criminal offence or who are advocates of, or active supporters of, extremist behaviour of a violent, separatist or destabilising nature.

3.15.11.7 The strengthening of the customs and immigration services and the vigorous enforcement of the law. The English Democrats recognise that successive Labour and Tory governments have handed over control of immigration to the EU to such an extent that it is impossible to regain proper control of immigration without leaving the EU.

3.15.12 The English Democrats firmly support withdrawal from the EU, subject to referendum approval, and will campaign forcefully to that end. Once the UK has left the EU full border controls can be restored.

3.16 England and Multi-Culturalism

3.16.1 It is a fact that during the past forty years people of many different cultures have come to live in England. Our country is in that sense a multi-cultural society. However, *multi-Culturalism* is an ideology which suggests that a mix of many cultures in one society is desirable and that it is the duty of government to actively encourage cultural diversity within the state. Further, it suggests that all cultures should be treated as equal. A logical extension of this is that all languages, histories and law codes should be treated equally. This is clearly impossible in a unified country. All ethnic groups should be free to promote their own culture and identity but the public culture of England should be that of the indigenous English. This position is consistent with the

rights of indigenous nations everywhere.

3.17 The English

3.17.1 It is common for those who assert their English identity to be challenged in a way that would be considered insulting if directed elsewhere. So as to avoid misunderstanding, and to meet the demands of those who are hostile to any assertion of Englishness, we have set out below what we mean by *the English*.

3.17.2 The English can be defined in the same way that other nations are defined. To be English is to be part of a community. We English share a communal history, language and culture. We have a communal identity and memory. We share a 'we' sentiment; a sense of belonging. These things cannot be presented as items on a checklist. Our community, like others, has no easily defined boundaries but we exist and we have the will to continue to exist.

3.18 The People of England

3.18.1 *The people of England* are all those UK citizens who live in England.

3.18.2 In electoral terms, the people of England are all those UK citizens who are on the electoral roll of an English constituency.

3.18.3 The people of England therefore includes the people of many nations, all of whom share a common UK citizenship.

3.19 Political Correctness

3.19.1 The English Democrats share the public concerns as to the harm caused to our society by political correctness.

3.19.2 The English Democrats unreservedly condemn this intolerant creed. We reject the self-righteousness of political correctness and condemn the ideology as an evil. Political correctness is incompatible with a free and democratic society.

3.19.3 One key aspect of political correctness is that a person, an institution or a government is politically correct when they cease to represent the interests of the majority, and become focused on the deliberate subversion of English national culture and interests, the denigration of English history and of the English themselves, and the promotion of the objectives of minority pressure groups.

3.19.4 Political correctness is grounded in the capture of state institutions, with official spokespeople, legislative powers and sanctions for breaches of political correctness. It is this capture of state institutions which makes political correctness so oppressive and dangerous. This must end.

3.19.5 The English Democrats will take whatsoever measures are necessary to remove political correctness from both national and local government, including the various quangos and other government bodies funded either directly or indirectly by the taxpayer. These measures will include the following three steps:

3.19.5.1 Firstly, those educational establishments, legal establishments, quangos, departments or other government organisations that are promoting political correctness will be fundamentally reconstituted and/or have their funding withdrawn or, where appropriate and if possible, be closed down. In particular, the so-called Commission for Equality and Human Rights will be closed. Private organisations that promote political correctness will not be awarded government contracts.

3.19.5.2 Secondly, the English Democrats recognise that those institutions that are run by state appointees are the most detached from public opinion and are more likely to become politically correct. The English Democrats will, where practical, ensure that senior public employees, such as police chief constables and senior judges, are democratically approved by the community they serve. This will be achieved either via direct elections or via approval by democratically elected representatives. Many senior public posts will be subject to a maximum occupancy period, for such senior public employees to be accountable to the public will form a part of a bulwark against political correctness.

3.19.5.3 Thirdly, the English Democrats will carry out a review of all laws and regulations, and will amend or, where appropriate and if possible, completely repeal those laws and regulations that foster and promote political correctness.

3.20 St George's Day

3.20.1 The people of England should be able to celebrate St George's day as a National Holiday.

3.21 Sport

3.21.1 The English Democrats support full independence of the English Nation in international sport. In particular, an England team in all team sports in internationally recognised competitions, an English Olympic Committee, and the right of all players in individual sports to describe themselves as being of English Nationality.

3.22 A Parliament for England

3.22.1 The English Democrats welcome the creation of a Scottish Parliament and seek a well thought out constitutional settlement that is fair to all parts of the United Kingdom. This should include parliaments for England and Wales, and a reformed Second Chamber at Westminster.

3.22.2 Our objective is the creation of an English Parliament, Executive and First Minister with at least the same powers as the Scottish Parliament, Executive and First Minister within a federal UK and a reformed Second Chamber at Westminster.

3.22.3 There should be fiscal devolution so that the English, Scottish, Welsh and N. Irish parliaments become responsible for financing their own expenditure. This will save the taxpayers of England a substantial amount of money.

3.22.4 We reject the plans for regional assemblies because, among other things, they will promote disunity and conflict within England.

3.22.5 The full extent of devolution and constitutional reform during the next two decades is difficult to foresee. The current Scottish model may mark the limit of reform or it may go further and give rise to a federal constitution or complete independence for Scotland. We recognise that the future shape of the United Kingdom is therefore to a large extent dependent upon the wishes of the people of Scotland. However, whatever course devolution takes, we favour the retention of a constitutional monarchy and a continuing association between the existing parts of the United Kingdom, albeit within a different constitutional framework.

3.22.6 If the United Kingdom should break-up, we would seek a new special relationship between the parts. This could be pursued through a Council of the Isles, an organisation similar to the Nordic Council in which all members are treated as equals. Representatives serving on the Council would seek areas where members could co-operate for their mutual benefit.

3.23 The Constitutional Case for Reform

3.23.1 It was Tam Dalyell, the Labour MP for West Lothian, who asked why MPs representing Scottish constituencies should be able to vote in the UK Parliament on matters affecting England (e.g. health and education) when MPs representing English constituencies are unable to vote on similar matters affecting Scotland? There are some, like Lord Chancellor Irvine, a Scotsman, who suggest that the best way to deal with the West-Lothian question is not to ask or answer it. Such insufferable arrogance is a very good reason for opening the position of Lord Chancellor to public election.

3.23.2 Of at least equal importance to who is able to vote on legislation, is who is able to initiate policies and legislation. MPs representing Scottish and Welsh constituencies can be appointed as Ministers (e.g. transport) and thereby initiate policies that affect only England. In a similar way they can, as members of the Cabinet, take part in the formulation of policy and legislation for England.

3.23.4 Furthermore, legislation affecting only England is subject to scrutiny and amendment in the House of Lords, whereas Scottish legislation on devolved matters is not subject to the approval of a second chamber.

3.23.5 There is also the issue of English under representation in the House of Commons -England has 40 fewer MPs than is warranted by its population size. This means that English votes are worth less than Scottish votes.

3.23.6 Finally, the Barnett formula, which was devised in 1978 to undermine support for the Scottish National Party, is grossly unfair to England. It was justified on the grounds that there needed to be 20% higher expenditure in Scotland in order to bring its public services up to the standard in England. The allocation of funds was to be based on relative *need*. There has been no assessment of need since 1976. In 1997 Scotland was the third richest *region* in the UK with a provision of public services that far exceeded those available in many parts of England. The formula is clearly a political expedient and not based on a proper assessment of need. Many parts of England are more deserving of special funding than is Scotland. The Barnett formula should be ended immediately and a new scheme devised that would both direct resources to those parts of England which are in greatest need and raise standards generally.

3.23.7 It can be seen that solutions like the one proposed by the Conservative Party, known as 'English votes on English laws', will neither redress the unfair treatment of the people of England nor help produce a coherent constitutional settlement. It is a completely inadequate response to the problems outlined above. A remedy must address much more than who votes for what. It needs to consider who initiates policy and who has a mandate to do so. The Conservative Party has so far been unable to offer a sensible solution to the problem because it is obsessed by the need to preserve *the Union* at whatever the cost to England. Their obsession is a weakness, which Scottish politicians in Scotland, in Westminster, and in government, are able to take advantage of.

3.23.8 The Labour Party and government are dominated and controlled by Scots so it is understandable that they should be enthusiastic about a Scottish Parliament and the preservation of Scottish identity. A more pressing reason for the creation of a Scottish Parliament was their concern to preserve the dominant position of the Labour Party in Scotland. In their actions they feel no guilt about giving preferential treatment to Scotland. They clearly have little empathy with the English or their interests.

3.23.9 The Liberal Democrats and their former Scottish leader Charles Kennedy, despite their frequently expressed concerns for democracy and fairness, are opposed to putting those ideals into effect by allowing the people of England to have a parliament of their own.

3.24 The Barnett Formula

3.24.1 In 1996/7, total expenditure per head of population on services in Scotland was 24% higher than in England. That figure is for all public service and welfare spending, including that on social security. If we look at spending in those policy areas which have been devolved to Scotland, it can be seen that spending is on average 31% per person higher in Scotland than in England. Spending in Scotland on health and personal social services was 22% higher; education 31% higher; transport 31% higher; trade, industry, energy and employment 55% higher; housing 87% higher; agriculture 123% higher. This additional funding for Scotland under the Barnett formula amounts to £12 billion each year.

3.24.2 This unjustified and unfair institutionalised discrimination against the people of England will not end until they make their displeasure known. One way of doing that is to join and vote for the ENGLISH DEMOCRATS.

3.25 Monmouthshire

3.25.1 The English Democrats consider that the position of Monmouthshire in Wales is anomalous, as historically it had mostly been part of England until recent boundary re-organisation. Accordingly, we would wish to see a county referendum in Monmouthshire as to whether the people of Monmouthshire would wish to be treated as being part of Wales or part of England.

3.26 Policy on Council Tax/Domestic Rates

3.26.1 Our policy is:-

3.26.1.1 Democratic national devolution for England.

3.26.1.2 The council tax or domestic rates systems in English, Wales and Scotland differ from one another. Scotland can set its own domestic rates system and Wales is likely to be in a similar situation in the near future. The domestic rates system in England and any changes to it should be controlled by an English Government and not the British Government.

3.26.1.3 Fairer funding for England resulting from the abolition of the Barnett formula will significantly improve resources made available to English local authorities. This increase will allow English local authorities to reduce rates or to provide additional services without increasing rates in real terms.

3.26.1.4 Longer term changes to local authority funding and to the domestic rates structure in England can then be considered and in the context of any proposed changes to other policies, such as business rates, abolition of the pension fund tax credit and the powers and authority of local authorities in England relative to the powers and authority of an English Government to ensure that local taxes fairly reflect people's ability to pay.

3.27 English Tourism

3.27.1 The English Democrats call for British Tourism to be converted into English tourism bodies, focused on the growth of the English tourist industry. This reflects the fact that national tourism bodies now operate for Scotland, Wales and N. Ireland.

SECTION 4 – The English Democrats Constitution

4.1 The Party Name

4.1.1 The party shall be called the “English Democrats”

4.2 Constitution

4.2.1 The Constitution of the English Democrats sets out how the Party will regulate its activities so that its actions and policies reflect the will of the members of the Party and are in accordance with regulatory requirements and general standards of propriety and regularity.

4.2.3 The members of the Party must approve, by ballot, the Constitution of the English Democrats and any amendments thereto. The National Council may make interim amendments to the constitution where the National Conference explicitly delegates authority for this; all such amendments must be subsequently approved by the members or lapse. Approval of amendments must be by at least a 50% majority of those voting.

4.3 Manifesto

4.3.1 The general principles, objectives and policies of the English Democrats are contained in its manifesto. The National Council is responsible for developing the manifesto and it is for the Conference to accept or reject it in its entirety.

4.4 Policy

4.4.1 The day-to-day adoption and amendment of Party policy shall be the responsibility of the National Council. All such policy shall conform with and give expression to the general principles and objectives of the Party as set out in its manifesto.

4.5 Objectives and Methods

4.5.1 **Objectives**–the English Democrats’ principal objectives shall be:

4.5.1.1 To build a more democratic and accountable society;

4.5.1.2 To secure a parliament and executive (government) for England;

4.5.1.3 To gain sufficient electoral support to form the executive (government) of England.

4.5.1.4 To advocate and put into effect the aims and objectives set out in its manifesto.

4.5.2 Methods

4.5.2.1 The English Democrats shall pursue its aims by means of political activity, democratically organised by members of the party freely associating together according to the provisions of the constitution.

4.6 Membership

- 4.6.1 Membership of the Party is open to all those, aged 16 years or over, who broadly agree with its aims, objectives, and policies.
- 4.6.2 Membership can be acquired by anyone, whatever their ethnicity, religion or culture, who;
- 4.6.2.1 Has affirmed in writing his or her intention to join the English Democrats.
 - 4.6.2.2 Is willing to further the aims of the party.
 - 4.6.2.3 Is not a member of any political party or body contesting elections in opposition to the English Democrats.
 - 4.6.2.4 Agree to abide by the Constitution and Standing Orders of the party;
 - 4.6.2.5 Has been accepted into membership by the National Council;
 - 4.6.2.6 Has paid the annual membership fee, as determined from time to time by the National Council.
 - 4.6.2.7 The National Council shall have the right to expel from membership any person who no longer complies with the requirements of paragraph 3.1 and 3.2 above, or whose behaviour is otherwise damaging to the interests of the party. Any member so expelled shall have the right of appeal to the Appeals Panel.
 - 4.6.2.8 Notwithstanding compliance with 3.1 and 3.2 above, membership may be refused or revoked if there is material disagreement, evidenced by conduct, with the fundamental values and objectives of the party or admission or continued membership would be likely to bring the party into disrepute.
 - 4.6.2.9 Any person aggrieved by such a refusal or revocation shall, subject to having exhausted the internal procedures have a right of appeal to the Appeals Panel.

4.7 National Conference

- 4.7.1 The Conference shall be responsible for;
- 4.7.1.1 Approving the party's manifesto;
 - 4.7.1.2 Electing the Party Chairman
 - 4.7.1.3 Electing ten members of the National Council; and
 - 4.7.1.4 Approving the Treasurer's Report.
- 4.7.2 The Conference shall consist of;
- 4.7.2.1 All Members of the National Council;
 - 4.7.2.2 Representatives of Area Councils as established by the National Council;
 - 4.7.2.3 Ordinary members of the party
- 4.7.3 The conference shall be convened and conducted in accordance with the Conference Standing orders.

4.8 The National Council

- 4.8.1 The National Council shall be responsible for:
- 4.8.1.1 Developing the policies of the party in depth.
 - 4.8.1.2 Determining the party's strategies and tactics.
 - 4.8.1.3 Preparing the party's election manifestos.
 - 4.8.1.4 Electing from among its members the Treasurer and Secretary.
 - 4.8.1.5 Ensuring that proper arrangements are made for the Party Conference.
 - 4.8.1.6 Ensuring that proper arrangements are made for the election of the Party Leader.
 - 4.8.1.7 Implementing any decisions which the Conference has directed to it.
 - 4.8.1.8 Appointing the members of the Appeals Panel.
 - 4.8.1.9 The National Council shall cause to be drawn up and maintained, as and when required, the following sets of Standing Orders and rules:
 - a) Standing Orders for the National Council.
 - b) Standing Orders for the National Council Executive.
 - c) Standing Orders and rules for Branches and Area Councils.
 - d) Financial rules.
 - e) Rules for the selection of the National Council.
 - f) Rules for the selection of Westminster Parliamentary candidates.

- g) Rules for the selection of local government candidates.
- h) Rules for the selection of European Parliamentary candidates.
- i) Rules for the selection of House of Lords candidates.

4.8.2 Meetings of the National Council shall be conducted in accordance with the Standing Orders of the Council.

4.8.3 Membership of the National Council (Between 11 to 20 in number) shall be:

- 4.8.3.1 The Party Chairman and ten members elected at Conference.
- 4.8.3.2 Nine Area representatives, Areas being European Parliament constituencies, as and when Areas are formed.
- 4.8.3.3 Members elected to the National Council shall serve for a term of two years.
- 4.8.3.4 Members of the National Council have basic obligations to attend National Council meetings, to present a short report to the National Council on what they have been doing on behalf of the party since the last meeting and to take specified and agreed responsibilities and to ensure these are carried out as agreed.
- 4.8.3.5 A member may be removed from the National Council in the event of a Council Member missing 3 consecutive National Council Meetings without adequate explanation and or failing to undertake agreed actions without acceptable explanation. Removal will be determined by a vote of the National Council.
- 4.8.3.6 The National Council can co-opt people onto the National Council in the event of a vacancy arising on the National Council. The position shall be subject to election in the normal way at the next general meeting of the Party.
- 4.8.3.7 The nomination of member(s) for election to membership of the National Council or Party Chairman shall be by a member of the Party and supported by a second Party member and neither of whom are the member nominated. The nomination shall also be supported by the member nominated.
- 4.8.3.8 Nomination for members of the National Council shall (excepting as noted in 5.12 below) be in writing and forwarded to the Secretary of the Party 21 days prior to the general meeting of the Party.
- 4.8.3.9 The election of member to the National Council will be by a ballot of members. Participation in the ballot will be either by personal attendance at the general meeting or by proxy.
- 4.8.3.10 In the event of a position not being filled through prior nomination (see 5.9 above) and election, vacant positions may be filled by nomination at a general meeting of the Party

4.9 Executive officers and groups

4.9.1 The National Council may appoint, as it sees fit, such officers or working groups to further the objectives of the party and this may include;

- 4.9.1.2 Implementing the decisions of the Conference and the National Council.
- 4.9.1.3 Organising and directing national campaigns.
- 4.9.1.4 Managing the organisation and finance of the party;
- 4.9.1.5 Developing policies;
- 4.9.1.6 Managing the party's assets.

4.9.2 The roles of the Officers shall be as follows unless Standing Orders, or legal requirements, or a decision of the National Council, direct(s) otherwise;

- 4.9.2.1 The Party Chairman shall be responsible for chairing all meetings of the Party.
- 4.9.2.2 The Secretary: All official communications to and from the Party shall be through the Secretary who will keep copies of all correspondence and make it available to members of the National Council.
- 4.9.2.3 The Treasurer shall manage the party's national finances and undertake such duties as required by the financial scheme agreed with the Electoral Commission.

4.10 Area Councils

4.10.1 The powers and roles of Area Councils shall be determined by the National Council.

4.11 Resolution of Conflicts

4.11.1 There shall be an Appeals Panel for the English Democrats, which shall consist of three members appointed by the National Council. Members of the Appeals Panel may be members of the National Council but hold the positions of Party Leader, Party Chairman, Treasurer, Secretary or any executive position.

4.11.2 The Appeals Panel shall adjudicate on:

4.11.2.1 Any dispute over the interpretation of any of the clauses of this constitution;

4.11.2.2 Any claim that the rights under this constitution of a member or of a Party body have been infringed, provided that no appeal may be brought under this paragraph where there is another appeal procedure;

4.11.2.3 Any matter expressly so provided by this constitution or by rules made hereunder.

4.11.2.4 The Panel may make and publish rules for its own procedure.

4.11.2.5 Any decision of the Panel shall be binding on all parties concerned provided it is considered and supported by the National Council.

4.12 Standing orders of the National Council

4.12.1 A quorum shall be formed by 4 or more of the members of the National Council, as they are defined in the constitution of the English Democrats.

4.12.2 The Chair shall be taken by the Chairman or in his/her absence, the meeting shall elect an acting Chair from amongst those present.

4.13 Financial rules

4.13.1 All bank accounts of the English Democrats shall be subject to the authority of the National Council and shall only be opened or closed by resolution of the National Council. Bank mandates shall be approved at a meeting of the National Council. Authorised signatories on cheques, standing orders, direct debits etc shall always include the person, normally the Treasurer, denoted at the time by the National Council to be responsible for keeping the party's accounts.

4.13.2 The financial year of the English Democrats will be from 1 January to 31 December.

4.13.3 The National Council will cause financial accounts to be prepared within 4 months of the end of the financial year and those accounts to be audited.

4.13.4 No paid employment or contract for the supply of goods or services shall be offered, granted or awarded on behalf of the English Democrats except by a person or persons authorised for that purpose by the National Council.

4.13.5 Appointments or contracts may be awarded to members of the National Council or to companies in which such a person has a financial interest provided that such an award is:

4.13.5.1 Approval in advance by the National Council; and

4.13.5.2 Subsequently reported in the annual reports and accounts of the English Democrats.

4.13.6 The Treasurer's reports to the National Council must be in writing and must include details of the party's bank accounts and income and expenditure in the format approved by the National Council.

4.13.7 The Treasurer shall present to the annual conference financial statements that shall include a statement of income and expenditure for the previous financial year and a balance sheet for the end of that year, both in a format approved by the National Council.

4.13.7 The National Council shall agree, annually, to a budget showing the projected income and expenditure for the party in a format agreed by the National Council from time to time.